

Isaiah 24:11 *There is a crying for wine in the streets; all joy is darkened, the mirth of the land is gone.*

In their book, Fearfully and Wonderfully Made, Dr. Paul Brand and Philip Yancey, make an attempt to do what they call, “A Surgeon’s look at the Human and Spiritual Body”. Their book explores the complex piece of creation called the human body. With knowledge gained from the world of science and medicine, they probe deep into the world of cells, bones, skin, muscle, and nerves to show how the human body so authentically expresses spiritual reality.

And they take from David’s writing a phrase suggesting that this creature from God is truly fearfully and wonderfully made.

Saint Augustine said, “Men go abroad to wonder at the height of mountains, at the huge waves of the sea, at the long courses of the rivers, at the vast compass of the ocean, at the circular motion of the stars; and they pass by themselves without wondering.

For centuries the body has been the mystical creation that eludes the reality of mankind. When you stop and think of the creation, and the makeup of Adam and eventually us, it blows the mind. How can something so complex and so detailed, come from something so common. We are from dirt, my friends.

Yet somehow when creating this complex body, God so designed it with something inside that has never been found by the microscope or other probing instruments.

Inside that body lies the part that was left void and vacant. Empty was how Job called it. Solomon said to fill it with anything but God was simply vanity.

There lies inside each man, woman, boy, and girl that place...a place so put there by God. That place is void of satisfaction, empty of comfort, and without real peace until the creator come and fills it with a divine presence.

That place cannot be filled by games or garments; it cannot be satisfied with pleasures or personal gain; it will never be complacent with the world's allurements or wonders of the flesh.

Whether you reside in America or Africa; Europe or England; the North or South Pole, you cannot find anything that will fill this position outside the realm of the Almighty God, Jehovah, King of Kings, Lord of Lord, the Great I AM, Jesus Christ. Inside that intricate body, lies the personal position that God put there which is designed so as to only accept His will and plan.

You can fill it with things but like the Teflon of a pan, they won't stick. They come and go and go and go until they no longer satisfy. The old song so capably describes this dilemma of mankind.

“Only Jesus Can Satisfy Your Soul.
Only He can change your life
And make your whole.
He'll give you peace, you never knew,
Sweet Love and joy, and heaven too,
For Only Jesus Can Satisfy Your Soul.”

All of creation groans and utters pains of hopelessness without this presence in their lives. A person or group of people can attempt to find and gain and hold to things and pleasures and gain, only to find it filled with nothing.

There is a divine presence that is needed to satisfy and fill the longing of the creation of God. He breathed into Adam the breath of life. He still needs to breathe into humanity a breath that provides not just the natural life but the eternal life that is so necessary for future survival.

We need Him. Oh, how we need Him. This need is as much reality as it is for a baby to need its mother at birth. WE need Him. How do I know? As the kids sing the song, I know, because the Bible tells me so.

O fear the Lord, you his saints, for those who fear him have no want! Ps. 34:9 RSV

The Lord will guide you continually, and satisfy your desire with good things. Is. 58:11 RSV

Let him that is athirst come. And whosoever will, let him take the water of life freely. Rev. 22:17

I am the bread that gives life. No one who comes to me will ever be hungry. No one who has faith in me will ever be thirsty. John 6:35 CEV

For He satisfies the longing soul, and fills the hungry soul with goodness. Ps. 107:9 NKJV

The Lord is my shepherd; I shall not want. Ps. 23:1

God is, must be our answer to every question and every cry of need
– *H.W. Smith*

We should learn to live in the presence of the living God. He should be a well for us – delightful, comforting, unfailing, springing up to eternal life. When we rely on other people, their

water supplies ultimately dry up. But the well of the Creator never fails to nourish us. – *Charles Haddon Spurgeon*

When I rely on myself, God's perfect answer is lost. But when I rely on God, my shortsighted answer is lost. I need Him. You need Him. The world needs Him. Everyone needs Him.

I cannot take the time to review the scene the prophet Isaiah saw. His vision of things happening in that day was one of horror. And even though I refuse to take the time to elaborate on the details, please notice with me the words and phrases that this old prophet uses to describe the scene.

Empty, waste, emptied and utterly spoiled, the earth fadeth; the covenants defiled, transgression of the law, ordinances changed, the everlasting covenant broken,.

Notice the response when discussing the joy of the land. The merry-hearted do sigh; the mirth of the tambourine ceases, the noise of the jubilant ends, the joy of the harp ceases.

Then he describes the city. The city of confusion is broken down, every house is shut up, the gate is stricken with destruction.

How horrible. What a terrible scene.

But in the midst of all the descriptions and illustrations, the prophet makes mention of one thing of importance. He said that there was a crying for wine in the streets!

Sure, that was then and this is now. No one is crying like this today. In fact, just read the paper.

In today's paper, let me tell you what the cry is all about:

Four soldiers killed in Iraq and 6 injured in guerrilla attacks.
Promoter in Las Vegas offered to take men on “Hunting for Bambi” safaris in which they could hunt down naked young women with paintball guns was arrested for not having a business license.

Marine sergeant arrested on multiple counts of lewd battery and providing obscenities in the sexual abuse of six boys he met at church.

Cancer, humanity’s foe, is not going quietly and researchers have come to accept that a miracle cure isn’t likely.

Three temblors in Japan injure 421, level hundreds of homes.

Three men charged in ambush shooting in which a man was killed and another injured outside a Jackson County Arkansas home.

A 15 year-old Cave City boy was killed Friday when an 18 inch piece of concrete pipe fell off a tractor-trailer rig and when through the windshield of the vehicle in which he was riding.

Sounds to me like there is crying in the street for the death of soldiers; and for the abuse of people; and for the horror of cancer. Seem like the crying in the streets is all because of world disasters and shootings and young people dying.

No one is crying for wine, preacher. Where is the relevance?

It’s simple. In the scriptures there are many metaphors and types that provide description as to why a writer was speaking. Wine is one of them. Wine in the New Testament is symbolic of the presence of God or the Holy Ghost.

Peter stood with the eleven at Pentecost and after being accused of drinking strong drink, said, “*these are not drunk as ye suppose...*” He did not deny they were drunk, just not drunk with strong drink. These were filled with the Holy Ghost and the presence of God in ones life makes a total difference.

There is a cry going on in our world. Crying for a solution; crying for a result; crying for help; crying for direction; crying for hope.

There is a crying going on in the streets and whether people accept it or not, it is a cry for the wine of God's presence.

The world needs more than religion...it needs the presence of the Almighty.

This world needs more than just a vision for the future...it needs a hope for the future that can only be found in the presence of God.

This world needs more than a lofty idea that will help it become better...it is in desperate need of the Holy Ghost flowing in their inner most being.

This world is crying. Crying for help and solutions and answers. This world is crying. They need to have the Holy Ghost wine flowing through their lives.

This church needs a brand new touch of the Holy Ghost so that it can flow through the streets of the city.

Wine was a medicine in the Biblical days and still is in some areas. God knows that we need spiritual medicine today. This world needs something that will cleanse it from the filth, the sin, the evil, the degradation that is so obvious today. There is a cry for wine.

We need the wine of the spirit moving in our lives so that we stay clean and pure with all righteousness.

Wine was used as a means to help people sleep and rest and relax. This world is in turmoil and chaos. There is an upheaval everywhere. It needs something to calm it down; to provide it with rest; to grant comfort and relief. There is a cry for wine.

Not only does the world need rest, but the church needs rest. We need the comfort of the Holy Ghost in our lives.

Wine was used as a means of celebration especially that of joyful occasions. This world needs a real celebration...not superficial, not made up, but a real celebration because joy is available.

Not only does the world need some joy, but the church needs some joy. We need the joy of the Holy Ghost...for with joy shall you draw waters from the wells of salvation. Give me joy.

Wine was used as a means of releasing tension that ultimately caused sickness. It was a preventive that could assist in the removal of stress and diseases related to stress and tension. This world is tense and stressed out...one good dose of the Holy Ghost would provide relief.

The church needs relief also. Tension, stress, worry, fear...all are no longer worldly symptoms...they belong to the church. We need to get a dose of the Holy Ghost to provide relief.

There is a cry in the street for wine! Give us the Holy Ghost. Refresh us with the Holy Ghost. Cleanse us with the Holy Ghost. Heal us with the Holy Ghost.

Give us joy, peace, righteousness, relief, comfort, guidance, direction, power, strength...all available through the Holy Ghost wine!

Instead of crying over our problems...cry for wine.
Instead of crying because of our hurts...cry for wine.
Instead of crying for fear...cry for wine.
Instead of crying for our sickness...cry for wine.
Instead of crying because of sadness...cry for wine.

I can remember in years gone by when we had a problem, the solution was go pray through. If you had a worry, you were told to go pray through. If you were hurt by someone, just go pray through. While I've been guilty of saying that praying through is not the answer to all our problems, I will say it is the solution to the inner soul's problems.

The song of the world proposes to have the answer by its lyrics: What the world needs now is love, sweet love. No. It needs a drink of the heavenly wine from the throne of God. The church needs to pour itself another drink of God's Holy Ghost that was poured out on the day of Pentecost.

A few short days after Pentecost, you will find the church and its disciples in trouble. They were having worldly problems, so Peter and the other disciples decided to hold a prayer meeting. Just a few days after Pentecost they met together and prayed. And the Bible says that the place where they prayed was shaken and they were all filled with the Holy Ghost! They went back to Joel's place and got filled all over again.

That's the answer today. That's the solution for the church. In the midst of turmoil within; while all the chaos is happening to us; when people have their feelings hurt; when you don't feel like praising Him; when you would rather stay at home because of what has happened...just go back to the place where you found that refreshing feeling originally.

Get a fresh touch of His presence. Cry for the wine of the Spirit to flood your soul. Allow the Almighty to surge through you once again. Find out how it feels to have Him take over and feel the relief.

Let me hear a cry for wine instead of crying for hurt.
Oh for a cry for wine instead of crying for loneliness.

Just to have some crying for a fresh move of God inside and you will see a fresh move of God all around.

When the church is filled with the Spirit, the world is watching and longing. When the church is filled, the world will want it. When the church is filled, outreach become easy. When the church is filled, grace is applicable. Give me a church that is hungry and thirsty for the wine of the Holy Ghost and I'll show you a church filled with God's power.

Anyone here want to cry for wine?